R&D | RetailPulse

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Report Writing Guidelines

> **In simple words**
>
> This document explains how to write the final report so that each page gives a clear finding and a clear action.

1. Report structure (target: 8 to 10 pages)

Section	What to write	Length
1. Executive Summary	Question, 3 main findings, 3 recommendations. Use the template in Doc 13.	1 page
2. Business Context	Problem, decisions, stakeholders	half page
3. Data and Method	Data used, baseline rule, metrics, high-error rule, limits	1 page
4. Findings	One short section per insight (use the insight card from Doc 12)	3 to 4 pages
5. Recommendations	Action table: action, owner, priority, evidence, how to measure	1 page
6. Limitations and Next Steps	What the data cannot tell, what to do next	half page
Appendix	Metric definitions, SQL file list, data checks	1 page

2. How to write a finding

1. **Headline:** the finding in one sentence.
2. **Evidence:** one chart and the key numbers.
3. **Compare:** against overall, another group or another period.
4. **Reason:** the likely cause. Say 'likely' unless the data proves it.
5. **Action:** what to do next.

3. Recommendation table (example format)

Action	Owner	Priority	Evidence	How to measure
[What to change]	[Team]	High / Medium / Low	[Finding and number]	[WAPE or Bias after change]

4. Writing rules

- Lead with the answer. Details come after.
- Use simple words. Explain a term the first time.
- Every number has a comparison (higher than what?).
- One message per chart. Put the message in the chart title.
- Use 'is linked to' or 'is likely caused by', not 'is caused by', unless proven.
- No invented numbers. If cost data is missing, say so and use units.

5. Presentation

Slide plan, speaker notes and the 2-minute story are in **Doc 13**.

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